James W.A. Strachan

Pronouns: *he/him*
Email : james.wa.strachan@gmail.com
Website : https://jwastrachan.com/
ORCID : 0000-0002-8618-3834
Telephone : (+44) 7403 369 385

Faculty of Governance, Economic & Social Sciences
Université Mohamed VI Polytechnique
Rabat, Morocco

(+212) 703 027465

BIOGRAPHY

Postdoctoral fellow (Teaching) — Mohamed VI Polytechnic University, Rabat MA
Faculty of Governance, Economic & Social Sciences — *2026 - 2027*

Humboldt Fellow / **Postdoc** — University Medical Center Hamburg-Eppendorf, Hamburg DE
Department of Neurology — *2023 - 2025*

MINDED Research Fellow — Italian Institute of Technology, Genoa IT
Cognition, Motion, and Neuroscience Unit — *2020 - 2022*

Postdoctoral Researcher — Central European University, Budapest HU
Department of Cognitive Science — *2016 - 2020*

PhD in Psychology — University of York, York UK
Professor Steve Tipper (thesis supervisor) — *2013 - 2017*

Thesis: Incidental learning of trust from identity-contingent gaze cues: boundaries, extensions and applications
Award date: July 14th 2017

MSc in Cognitive Neuroscience — University of York
Professor Andy Young (thesis supervisor) — *2012 - 2013*

Thesis: Involvement of the superior temporal sulcus in decoding social signals from faces

BSc in Psychology — University of York
2009 - 2012

JOURNAL ARTICLES

Strachan, J., Pansardi, O., Scaliti, E., Celotto, M., Saxena, K., Yi, C., Manzi, F., Rufo, A., Manzi, G., Graziano, M., Panzeri, S., Becchio, C., (2026). "GPT-4o reads the mind in the eyes". In: *Computers in Human Behaviour* 181, p. 108992.

Strachan, J., Albergo, D., Borghini, G., Pansardi, O., Scaliti, E., Gupta, S., Saxena, K., Rufo, A., Panzeri, S., Manzi, G., Graziano, M., Becchio, C., (2024). "Testing Theory of Mind in Large Language Models and Humans". In: *Nature Human Behaviour* 8, pp. 1285–1295.

Charbonneau, M., Curioni, A., McEllin, L., **Strachan, J.,** (2023). "Flexible cultural learning through action coordination". In: *Perspectives on Psychological Science* 19 (1), pp. 201–222.

Charbonneau, M., **Strachan, J.**, Winters, J., (2023). "The problem with solutions: Comment on "Blind alleys and fruitful pathways in the comparative study of cultural cognition" by Andrew Whiten". In: *Physics of Life Reviews* 44, pp. 61–63.

Charbonneau, M., **Strachan, J.,** (2022). "From Copying to Coordination: An Alternative Framework for Understanding Cultural Learning Mechanisms". In: *Journal of Cognition and Culture* 22, pp. 451–466.

Strachan, J., Curioni, A., Constable, M., Knoblich, G., Charbonneau, M., (2021). "Evaluating the relative contributions of copying and reconstruction processes in cultural transmission episodes". In: *PLOS One* 16 (9), e0256901.

Strachan, J., Török, G., (2020). "Efficiency is prioritised over fairness when distributing joint actions". In: *Acta Psychologica* 210, p. 103158.

Strachan, J., Constable, M., Knoblich, G., (2020). "It Goes With The Territory: Ownership Across Spatial Boundaries". In: *Journal of Experimental Psychology: Human Perception and Performance* 46 (8), pp. 789–797.

Strachan, J., Guttesen, A., Smith, A., Gaskell, M., Tipper, S., Cairney, S., (2020). "Investigating the formation and consolidation of incidentally learned trust". In: *Journal of Experimental Psychology: Learning, Memory and Cognition* 46 (4), pp. 684–698.

Strachan, J., Sebanz, N., Knoblich, G., (2019). "The role of emotion in the dyad inversion effect". In: *PLOS One* 14 (7), e0219185.

Strachan, J., Kirkham, A., Manssuer, L., Over, H., Tipper, S., (2017). "Incidental learning of trust from eye-gaze: Effects of race and facial trustworthiness". In: *Visual Cognition* 25 (7-8), pp. 802–814.

Strachan, J., Tipper, S., (2017). "Examining the durability of incidentally learned trust from gaze cues". In: *Quarterly Journal of Experimental Psychology* 70.10, pp. 2060–2075.

Strachan, J., Kirkham, A., Manssuer, L., Tipper, S., (2016). "Incidental learning of trust: Examining the role of emotion and visuomotor fluency". In: *Journal of Experimental Psychology: Learning, Memory and Cognition* 42, pp. 1759–1773.

Flack, T., Andrews, T., Hymers, M., Al-Mosaiwi, M., Marsden, S., **Strachan, J.**, Trakulpipat, C., Wang, L., Wu, T., Young, A., (2015). "Responses in the right posterior superior temporal sulcus show a feature-based response to facial expression". In: *Cortex* 69, pp. 14–23.

Book Chapters

Strachan, J., Begus, K., (2026). "Theory of Mind". In: *On Human Nature: Biology, Psychology, Ethics, Politics, and Religion*. Ed. by M. Tibayrenc. 2nd ed. Elsevier. In press, available for preorder; expected publication December 2026. ISBN: 9780443336911.

Strachan, J., Curioni, A., McEllin, L., (2024). "Flexible Social Learning of Technical Skills: The Case of Action Coordination". In: *The Evolution of Techniques: Rigidity and Flexibility in Use, Transmission, and Innovation*. Ed. by M. Charbonneau. The Vienna Series in Theoretical Biology, MIT Press. Chap. 6. ISBN: 9780262378390.

Strachan, J., Knoblich, G., Sebanz, N., (2020). "Skill and Expertise in Joint Action". In: *The Routledge Handbook of Philosophy of Skill and Expertise*. Ed. by C. Pavese and E. Fridland. Chap. 29.

Preprints and Working Manuscripts

Strachan, J., Mayo, R., Sebanz, N., (under review). *When thinking about your partner gets in the way: Coordination failures in joint decision-making*. Manuscript under review at Acta Psychologica. Preprint available from https://osf.io/szeuw/.

Zhao, Q., Pansardi, O., **Strachan, J.**, Scaliti, E., Manzi, G., Borghini, G., Manzi, F., Rufo, A., Vignemont F. M. G., Panzeri, S., Becchio, C., (under review). *Inverting the Turing Test reveals dissociations between encoding, readout and meta-readout*. Manuscript under review at Nature Communications.

Funding and Fellowships

Humboldt Research Fellowship for Experienced Researchers 2023-2024
Individual research fellowship by the Alexander von Humboldt Foundation *€57,060*

MINDED MSCA-COFUND Fellowship 2020-2022
Research fellowship awarded as part of MSCA-COFUND Action *Salary cover*

BA/Leverhulme Small Research Grants [SRG1920-100325; Co-PI] 2020
Learning who to trust: How do we re-affiliate after social exclusion? *£9,929*

Wellcome Trust: Centre for Chronic Diseases and Disorders [Co-investigator] 2016
Influencing Facial Trustworthiness in Sleep *£6,988*

Awards

YuFund, York Alumni Association £200
Grant for public engagement event Psych!York *2016*

Postgraduate Community Fund, York Graduate Student Association (GSA) £574
Grant for public engagement event Psych!York *2016*

International Meeting of the Psychonomic Society, Granada, Spain
Accommodation Award *2016*

UK National 3-Minute Thesis Competition
National Semi-Finalist *2015*

Supervision & Teaching

Note: All teaching has been delivered in English

Experimental Methods: Design and Data collection 2026-2027
UM6P, Rabat, Morocco

- **Degree programme:** Behavioral Sciences for Public Policy (2nd year undergraduate)
- **Number of students:** 23 students (in 2026)
- **Role:** Module organiser

- **Teaching form:** Lectures, lab sessions
- **Responsibilities:** Syllabus creation; Teaching delivery; Examinations; Marking
- **Evaluation:** 4.08 / 5 (2026)

Guest Lecturer November 2019

Eötvös Loránd University (ELTE), Budapest, Hungary

- **Course:** Introduction to Cognitive Science (1 semester)
- **Degree programme:** MSc in Computational and Cognitive Neuroscience
- **Number of students:** 40
- **Role:** Guest lecturer
- **Teaching form:** Classroom lecturing
- **Responsibilities:** Creating and delivering an individual lecture on joint attention and communicative gaze; Coordinating with course coordinator on topic and presentation

Guest Lecturer 2018-2019

Budapest University of Technology and Economics (BME), Budapest, Hungary

- **Course:** Introduction to Social Cognition (1 semester)
- **Degree programme:** MSc in Computational and Cognitive Neuroscience
- **Number of students:** 20
- **Role:** Guest lecturer
- **Teaching form:** Classroom lecturing
- **Responsibilities:** Creating and delivering an individual lecture on joint attention; Coordinating with course coordinator on topic and presentation

Graduate Teaching Assistant - Tutorial Lead 2013-2016

University of York, York, UK

- **Degree programme:** Psychology BSc (2 semesters per academic year, 9 1-hour slots per semester
- **Topics covered:** Cognitive Psychology; Social Psychology; Developmental Psychology; Perception; Attention; Cognitive Neuroscience; Research Methods; Statistics
- **Number of students:** 9 groups of c.15 students
- **Educational level:** Undergraduate
- **Role:** Teaching assistant
- **Teaching form:** Seminar groups; Paper discussions; Small-group classroom teaching
- **Responsibilities:** Leading a seminar group; Leading discussion; Small-group teaching; Seminar development on social cognition and perception; Coordination with course leader to develop learning objectives in line with course content; Training other teaching assistants on seminar content; Refining and revising seminar content

Graduate Teaching Assistant - Examination 2013-2016

University of York, York, UK

- **Degree programme:** Psychology BSc (2 semesters per academic year)
- **Number of students:** 30-40
- **Educational level:** Undergraduate
- **Role:** Teaching assistant
- **Teaching form:** Essay and report marking; Student feedback
- **Responsibilities:** Marking and evaluating student reports; Coordinating with course leader; Providing feedback to course leader on general trends in student performance for course refinement

Mentorship 2013-2022

University of York; CEU; IIT; UKE; UM6P

- **Number of Students:** 7 undergraduate students (University of York); 3 postgraduate interns (CEU; IIT; UKE); 1 Masters student (CEU/University of Vienna); 1 visiting undergraduate research assistant (UKE, from Northumbria University); 1 undergraduate research assistant (UM6P)
- **Responsibilities:** Mentorship of undergraduate and Masters student projects; Training in research methodology, data analysis, scientific writing, and presentations

James W.A. Strachan

Curriculum Vitae

Research Methods & Technical Skills

Methods: Motion capture (Vicon); Experimental design; Open Science

Programming: R; MATLAB; Python; Javascript

Languages: English (native); Italian (B2); German (B1); French (B1) *CEFR levels are approximate*

Professional Activities

External roles

Indeep AI
Advisor, Cognitive Science — *Since 2024*

Journal of Experimental Psychology: Human Perception & Performance
Consulting Editor — *Since 2020*

Ad-hoc reviewer

Acta Psychologica; Attention, Perception, and Psychophysics; British Journal of Psychology; Cognition; Cognition and Emotion; Cognitive Science; Communications Psychology; Experimental Psychology; Frontiers in Psychology; iScience; Journal of Archaeological Science; Journal of Experimental Psychology: Human Perception and Performance; Journal of Experimental Social Psychology; Journal of Nonverbal Behaviour; Nature Communications; PLOS One; PNAS; PNAS Nexus; Proceedings of the Royal Society A; Proceedings of the Royal Society B; Psychological Science; Psychonomic Bulletin & Review; Quarterly Journal of Experimental Psychology; Science Advances; Scientific Reports; Visual Cognition

Society Memberships

Marie Curie Alumni Association (MCAA)
Member — *Since 2022*

Cultural Evolution Society
Member — *Since 2026*

British Psychological Society
Eligible for graduate membership

Department Roles

Undergraduate entrance examinations — Jury member
FGSES, UM6P — *2026*

Impact and Engagement

Psych!York
Organising committee for all-day public engagement event staffed by early-career researchers — *2016*

Science and Technology Network Launch
Invited talk at Royal Institution, London — *2016*

PUBlic Seminar
Public engagement seminar. Won Audience Favourite prize — *2016*

Shine School Outreach Program
Outreach lecture to Yorkshire schools: Introduction to Psychology — *2016*

Science is Vital: York Chapter
Organised and hosted Science Is Vital event as part of national campaign — *2015*

YorNight Research Café
European Researchers Night — *2015*

York Graduate Research School Launch
Invited talk at the University of York — *2015*

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Strachan, J. (Nov. 2026). "Social learning of complex skills and the acquisition of expertise." Invited seminar at Northumbria University, Newcastle, UK.

Strachan, J. (Nov. 2025). "Social cognition in pedagogical interactions: Linking skill learning, communication, and joint action". Invited seminar at Aachen University, Aachen, Germany.

Strachan, J., Pansardi, O., Scaliti, E., Celotto, M., Saxena, K., Yi, C., Manzi, F., Rufo, A., Manzi, G., Graziano, M., Panzeri, S., Becchio, C., (July 2025). "GPT4o reads the mind in the eyes". Talk delivered at the tenth Joint Action Meeting (JAM X) 2025, Turin, Italy.

Strachan, J., Becchio, C., (Mar. 2024). "Kinematic signatures of pedagogical communication". Symposium talk delivered at the 66th Tagung experimentell arbeitender Psycholog:innen (TeaP; Conference of Experimental Psychologists).

Strachan, J., Albergo, D., Borghini, G., Pansardi, O., Scaliti, E., Rufo, A., Manzi, G., Graziano, M., Becchio, C., (Mar. 2024). "Testing Theory of Mind in GPT Models and Humans". Poster delivered at the 66th Tagung experimentell arbeitender Psycholog:innen (TeaP; Conference of Experimental Psychologists).

Strachan, J., Becchio, C., (July 2023). "Building demonstrations from scratch: Understanding pedagogical communication in teaching interactions". Talk delivered at ninth Joint Action Meeting (JAM 9) 2023, Budapest, Hungary.

Strachan, J., Török, G., (Mar. 2022). "Do people choose to be efficient or fair when allocating tasks in a joint action?" Symposium talk at the 64th Tagung experimentell arbeitender Psycholog:innen (TeaP; Conference of Experimental Psychologists).

Strachan, J., Charbonneau, M., Curioni, A., Constable, M., Knoblich, G., (Aug. 2020). "A methodology for distinguishing copying and reconstruction in cultural transmission episodes". Paper accepted for the 42nd Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society, online July 29-August 1, 2020.

Strachan, J., Charbonneau, M., Curioni, A., Constable, M., Sperber, D., Knoblich, G., (July 2019). "Active cultural transmission: Exploring the role of pedagogy in transmission and learning". Talk delivered at eighth Joint Action Meeting (JAM VIII) 2019, Genova, Italy.

Strachan, J., Török, G., Sebanz, N., (May 2019). "Investigating the role of fairness in task distribution". Poster presented at the Dubrovnik Conference on Cognitive Science (DuCog), 2019, Dubrovnik, Croatia.

Strachan, J., Mayo, R., Sebanz, N., (Mar. 2019). "The role of generalised distrust in coordinated decision-making". Symposium talk delivered at the International Convention of Psychological Science (ICPS) 2019, Paris.

Strachan, J., Török, G., Sebanz, N., (Mar. 2019). "When Being Efficient Is Unfair: Investigating the Role of Fairness in Task Distribution". Poster presented at the International Convention of Psychological Science (ICPS) 2019, Paris.

Strachan, J., Constable, M., Knoblich, G., (Oct. 2018). "Ownership Effects Across Territory Boundaries." Poster presented at DisSelf conference and workshop in Porto, Portugal.

Strachan, J., Török, G., Sebanz, N., (Sept. 2018). "To Be Fair... Investigating the drive towards fairness in task distribution". Poster presented at Social Cognition in Robots and Humans workshop in Hamburg, Germany.

Strachan, J., Mayo, R., Sebanz, N., (Aug. 2018). "Think For Yourself: When trying to coordinate leads to less efficient coordination strategies than acting individually." Symposium talk given at meeting of the British Psychological Society Cognitive Section at Liverpool Hope University.

Strachan, J., Knoblich, G., Sebanz, N., (Feb. 2018). "Perceiving dyads as perceptual units". Poster presented at the inaugural Interactive Eye Gaze Workshop at UCL, London.

Strachan, J., Knoblich, G., Sebanz, N., (July 2017). "Investigating the effect of joint speech on discrimination of truth". Poster presented at the seventh Joint Action Meeting (JAM VII) at Queen Mary University, London.

Strachan, J., Tipper, S., (Aug. 2016). "Incidental learning of trust does not result in distorted memory for the physical features of faces". Poster presented at the 39th European Conference on Visual Perception in Barcelona.

Strachan, J., Tipper, S., (May 2016). "Effects of Real-World Social Group Status on Incidental Learning of Trust." Poster presented at International Meeting of the Psychonomic Society, Granada.

Strachan, J., Tipper, S., (Jan. 2016). "Investigating the Durability of Incidentally Learned Trustworthiness Impressions". Talk presented at the January meeting of the Experimental Psychology Society, UCL, London.

Strachan, J. (Nov. 2015). "Learning to trust: Background learning of social information". Invited seminar, Wentworth College, University of York.

Strachan, J., Tipper, S., (July 2015). “Incidentally learning of traits from gaze cues generalises to judgements of unrelated stimuli”. Poster presented at Social Cognition Workshop, Bangor University.

Strachan, J., Tipper, S., (May 2015). “Using scalar ratings to track changes in apparent trustworthiness induced by helpful and misleading gaze cues”. Poster presented at Vision Sciences Society Annual Conference, St. Pete Beach, FL.